



KNOW HOW



❶ I have installed openSUSE 11.2 from the DVD provided with your magazine. It was running fine and I was enjoying it. I accidentally deleted the network manager icon that's in the bottom bar, by default. I have tried a lot to restore it but have not succeeded so far. Can you please help me add it back? I have tried adding different applets using 'Add to Panel' but even that did not work. I am using GNOME.

—Monalika, Patna

The network manager icon is a part of 'Notification Area' and can be added by right clicking the Panel → Add to Panel → selecting 'Notification Area' and adding it to the panel. Hope this works for you. If you want to do the same by using the terminal, then log in as the root user and you to:

```
#cd /home/user_name/.gconf/apps/
#mv panel panel_old
```

Log out and then log in to your user account. You will find your network manager icon in its place.



Note: This process will reset the panel apps to default and you will lose personal settings if there were any.

❷ I have downloaded the newly released openSUSE 11.3 and installed it on my old Compaq laptop. As usual, the wireless function did not work for me.

Please suggest how to make it work. It did not work on openSUSE 11.2 either, but I installed the drivers for the wireless card as mentioned in one of your suggestions in this section. I tried the same for openSUSE 11.3 also. I searched for a '1 click install' at <http://packman.links2linux.org> and tried to install by clicking on it, but got the error message shown below:

"Nothing to do: The install link or file you opened does not contain instructions for this version of openSUSE".

Below is the output of `lspci`, for your reference:

```
00:1f.3 SMBus: Intel Corporation 82801G (ICH7
Family) SMBus Controller (rev 01)
06:00.0 Network controller: Broadcom Corporation
BCM94311MCG wlan mini-PCI (rev 01)
```

Waiting for your reply to make my laptop rock...

—Samiuddin,

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If the '1 click install' from the packman did not work for you, try installing the firmware for your Broadcom wireless card (BCM94311MCG) by using the application `install-bcm43xx_` firmware. To install the firmware, follow the steps given below.

Step 1: Connect your laptop to the Internet using a wired connection or any CDMA/GSM wireless modem.

Step 2: Run the following as the root user:

```
#/usr/sbin/install-bcm43xx_firmware
```

This will download and extract `b43` and `b43legacy` firmware. Finally,

you will get a message saying that both firmware have been successfully installed.

Step3: Start your wireless hardware and configure it for your network.

❸ I have installed Linux on my Acer Travel Mate 2350. It is equipped with a 40 GB HDD, a Celeron processor and 512 MB of RAM. Till a few days back it was running fine. But, suddenly, I have started facing problems with it. The laptop hangs and stops responding. This condition lasts for a few seconds and thereafter everything is normal. The process gets repeated every few minutes. I have even reinstalled and checked logs but cannot find any solution.

Below is a part of the output of `dmesg` for your reference.

```
sd 0:0:0:0: [sda] Result: hostbyte=DID_OK
driverbyte=DRIVER_SENSE, SUGGEST_OK
sd 0:0:0:0: [sda] Sense Key : Medium Error
[current] [descriptor]
Descriptor sense data with sense descriptors
(in hex):
72 03 11 04 00 00 00 0c 00 0a 00 00 00 00 00
03 59 f9 24
sd 0:0:0:0: [sda] Add. Sense: Unrecovered read
error - auto reallocate failed
end_request: I/O error, dev sda, sector 56228132
ata1: EH complete
```

—Santosh Kumar,

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It's time to back up your data and replace the disk with a new one. You can also try recovering the disk by running `shred` with a zero pass on the entire disk. Sometimes this works but the urgent thing is to back up your data first, to be on a safer side. **END**